

Learn the low level. Ship real open source.

Compiling a bright future through open source.

think teaches justice-impacted learners the part of software that actually sets them apart: **the low level**. How a computer really works, from true zero, up through the kernel, Rust, and driving real hardware, all of it offline on a locked-down machine. Then it does what a certificate never can. It turns that learning into **shipped, merged open-source contributions**: public, permanent, verifiable proof of what you can do.

think is a reentry utility that teaches programming at a fundamental level; from 1s and 0s up through Rust, we help onboard justice-impacted individuals to the world of **open source** as a career-building initiative.

ONE-BREATH VARIANTS

Three ways to say the same position out loud (Penn, July 2026):

“think teaches people coming home to program from 1’s and 0’s up through Rust, and every project ships in public, building out tangible contributions to open source as a catalyst to career growth.”

“think teaches people coming home to program from 1’s and 0’s up through Rust, and every project ships in public, building out a range of contributions, from small doc changes up to full blown patches, which can directly impact hire-ability.”

“think teaches people coming home to program from 1’s and 0’s up through Rust, and every project ships in public, building out a range of different real world contributions, from doc changes up to real world drivers.”

WHAT YOU LEARN

Scarce, in-demand systems skills: kernel concepts, Rust, and real hardware. Not the crowded web-dev track everyone else teaches.

WHAT IT DOES

Takes you from “what is a program” to DOOM booting on a display you drove from the bare metal, with no experience and no hardware required. Self-paced, offline, and it cannot get stuck.

WHAT YOU SHIP

Not a certificate that says you attended. Real open-source contributions with your name on them, merged into software people use. A portfolio, not a promise.

WHY SHIPPING OPEN SOURCE, FOR THIS AUDIENCE

A record that does not ask about your past. The review judges the patch, not the person. Contributions are public and merit-judged; nobody asks where you have been.

Proof you can point to. 83% of organizations weigh open-source contributions when they hire. A merged patch outweighs a gap in your history, because it is evidence, not a claim.

A door, and a community. The work introduces you, through on-ramps that already exist (kernelnewbies, the Linux Kernel Mentorship Program, Outreachy).

A certificate says: I showed up. A merged patch says: I did this. It is in the code, my name is on it, and it is still there.

You learn the skills the industry is short on, and you ship them where the whole world can see. You do not graduate with a promise. You graduate with a history.

Source: 2024 Open Source Software Funding Survey (GitHub, the Linux Foundation, and Harvard): 83% of organizations say open-source contribution is at least somewhat important for prospective hires.